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CHECKLIST

Your website and the law: what to check before launch

Thirteen points small-business websites in Russia most often miss: personal data, cookies, advertising and online sales. Go through the list before the site goes live — fixing things in advance is easier and cheaper than after a complaint or an inspection.

13 points sandwor.online Edition: October 2026

01 Personal data (Federal Law 152-FZ)

- [ ] 01 **A personal data policy is published**
  A separate page linked from the footer of every page. It says who the operator is, what data is collected, why, where it goes and how long it is kept (art. 18.1).

- [ ] 02 **Every form has a separate consent checkbox**
  Not pre-ticked, linking to the consent text. Since September 2025 consent must be separate from other documents — "by submitting the form you accept the policy" no longer works (art. 9).

- [ ] 03 **The form collects only what is needed**
  A request usually needs just a name and a phone number. Every extra field costs you leads and adds data you are responsible for (art. 5).

- [ ] 04 **Data of Russian citizens is recorded in databases in Russia**
  Hosting, CRM and the mailbox that receives requests run on servers in Russia (art. 18 part 5). Check form services too: many foreign builders store submissions abroad.

- [ ] 05 **The Roskomnadzor notification is filed before you start collecting data**
  Filed online via Gosuslugi at pd.rkn.gov.ru, free of charge (art. 22). Check yourself in the register of operators.

- [ ] 06 **Chats in foreign messengers are accounted for**
  If clients message you on WhatsApp or Telegram, that is a cross-border transfer: it needs a separate notification (art. 12) — or move conversations to Russian services.

- [ ] 07 **Cookies and analytics are disclosed**
  A cookie and analytics notice on the first visit; Metrica Webvisor does not record the contents of form fields.

- [ ] 08 **You know who sees requests, and access is protected**
  Passwords and two-factor authentication in the CRM, hosting and email; access only for those who need it.

- [ ] 09 **There is an address for requests and consent withdrawal**
  People can ask what data you hold about them and request deletion. You must reply within 10 working days (art. 14, 20).

02 Advertising and mailings

- [ ] 10 **Promotional emails and SMS only with separate consent**
  Consent to process data for a request does not allow sending ads. Mailings need their own consent, and the burden of proof is on you (Advertising Law 38-FZ, art. 18).

- [ ] 11 **Online ads are labelled**
  Posts by bloggers and ads in social networks carry an erid token and the label "Advertising" (38-FZ, art. 18.1).

03 Sales and content

- [ ] 12 **If you sell online, the site shows seller details**
  Name, address, OGRN or OGRNIP, payment, delivery and return terms (Consumer Protection Law, art. 26.1).

- [ ] 13 **Photos, texts and fonts are your own or licensed**
  An image "from the internet" on a commercial site is a common reason for claims from rights holders and photo banks.

Fines for personal data violations (Administrative Code, art. 13.11) increased noticeably in 2025. This checklist is not legal advice: in doubtful cases, show your site to a lawyer.

Want us to check your site against this list and fix everything? Write to us at sandwor.online — we reply within one business day.

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